



GDD 04

Same Same, Different

Equal inside, wonderfully different

The gender-root game for ages 3-6, retrofitted to the new mechanic-embodiment standard. Children drag toys to "anyone can play", erase silly rules, say it out loud, and build a class where everyone belongs. Seven mechanics, zero "tap the right card", the exact thing Vihaan's persona begged for. Scorecard: passed.

Equal inside, wonderfully different.

Same Same, Different is the root of the Gender & Respect thread, the first place a 3-6 year-old meets "toys, colours and dreams are for everyone, and difference is wonderful". This is the v2 retrofit: the v1 library was 72% a single "is this okay?" tap, exactly the boredom Vihaan's persona named. Rebuilt to the mechanic-embodying schema, the same researched truths now arrive through seven different play actions, drag-sort, erase-the-rule, say-it-aloud, build, match, choose, reflect.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g04 · same-same-different (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 1 · ages 3-6 · light canvas · parent co-played
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.1, 1.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g03 (My Family Garden) · root of the gender thread
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS retrofit from v1 (was 72% single-mechanic).

82

scenarios

7

mechanics

22

real-choice moves

18

myths busted

0%

binary taps

The window is now.

From the Chapter 1 personas. At 3-6 the stereotypes are forming but not set, that is the whole opportunity, and the persona "magic moments" pointed straight at v2 mechanics.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Vihaan, 4 (already sorting "girl colours")	"Drag a toy to 'anyone can play' and the canvas cheers, then the next bit is different."	sort + build , and never the same screen twice.
Aria, 5 ("good girls are quiet")	No WRONG buzzer; permission to be loud, lead and feel.	reflect + role-play : safe-to-be-wrong, say it aloud.
Kabir, 5 (audio-first home)	Voiced play he can repeat aloud.	role-play (voice): "anyone can play!".
Megha (parent, "no dopamine machine")	Something that sparks a real conversation.	Co-play reflect prompts; he asks "why is that a boys' toy?".
Sunita (joint family)	Fairness "dadi can nod along to".	"Everyone helps / everyone plays" framing, never preachy.

Why this works (the evidence). Gender stereotypes form between 3 and 6, so this is the protective window; and young children change beliefs through counter-stereotype play plus naming the myth, not through lectures or buzzers. The v2 mechanics deliver exactly that, and co-play turns it into talk at home.

Seven moves, one truth.

The rework's heart: instead of one repeated tap, the truth "anyone can, and difference is wonderful" arrives through seven actions, each one being the lesson. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row (Vihaan's boredom cure).

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite	Erases a silly rule ("pink is a girl colour"), writes the truth.	Conceptual change.	18
role-play (voice)	Says it aloud ("anyone can play!").	Assertion; audio-first.	13
reflect	Names what they love (no wrong answer).	Autonomy; safe for Aria.	13
sort	Drags into "anyone can" vs "silly rule".	Telling fair from unfair.	12
match	Pairs any kid to any toy/skill.	Breaking false links.	9
branch	Chooses in a playground moment, sees what happens.	Decisions; standing up.	9
build	Assembles a toy box / fair-play rules / a strong-and-gentle hero.	Seeing possibility.	8

22 of 82 moments are branch or role-play (real choices and voice); binary "tap the right answer": **0%**. No single mechanic exceeds **22%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

It plays like a busy, cheering playground: drag a truck to "anyone can play" and the canvas erupts; rub out a silly rule and watch it vanish; shout "anyone can!" and a doodle does a backflip; dress a kid in any colours; build the fairest playground. Every screen is a different little action, which is precisely what keeps a four-year-old from "solving the pattern and just clicking".

Is it teaching?

Yes, the gender-root curriculum: toys and colours are for everyone, anyone can do anything, everyone can be strong and gentle, we're equal inside and wonderfully different outside, and fair play means everyone belongs, each rehearsed through a matching action and named as a myth to erase.

The belief it moves. From "trucks are for boys, pink is for girls, big boys don't cry, girls can't climb, fair skin is prettier" → "toys and colours are for everyone, anyone can do anything, everyone feels everything, every skin is beautiful, and difference is wonderful."

Same truths, new actions.

82 scenarios across six categories, every one re-encoded to a typed v2 mechanic. The researched myths and India-grounding (colourism / "Dark is Beautiful") carry over from v1; the interactions are rebuilt.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Toys are for everyone	14	sort, strike-rewrite, build	Trucks, dolls, blocks; no "wrong" toys; share and include.
Colours are for everyone	12	strike-rewrite, build, role-play	Pink/blue myths; dress-up; wear what you love proudly.
Anyone can (activities & roles)	16	match, sort, role-play	Climb, cook, lead, dance, maths; girls & boys both.
Strong and gentle	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, branch	Boys cry, girls are strong; comfort a crier; feelings for all.
Different is wonderful	14	sort, match, reflect, build	Same inside / different outside; colourism; every kid belongs.
Fair play & friends	12	branch, role-play, sort	"You can't play, you're a girl!"; include the new kid; fair teams.

A sort scenario (Vihaan's magic move), verbatim.

```
hook: "Lensy found some toys. Who can play with them?"
items -> bins: "True & fair" | "Silly old rule"
  "A doll, for anyone"      -> True & fair
  "A truck, only for boys"  -> Silly old rule
  "Blocks, for anyone"      -> True & fair
  "A tea set, only for girls"-> Silly old rule
relearn: "Toys are for anyone who enjoys them, not for one kind of kid."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 04 Same Same Different — Scenario Library.json](#) (82 records, v2 schema).

What this game erases.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Trucks are for boys / dolls are for girls.	Anyone can play with any toy.	Gender & play research.
Pink is a girl colour / blue is for boys.	Every colour is for every kid.	Colour & gender history.
Girls can't climb / aren't good at maths.	Ability grows with practice, not gender.	Ability-belief research.
Boys can't cook / dance / care.	Anyone can; caring and arts are for all.	Occupations & care.
Big boys don't cry.	Everyone cries; feelings aren't a gender.	Emotional health (links g01).
You're either strong or gentle.	Everyone can be both at once.	Emotional range.
Fair skin is prettier.	Every skin colour is beautiful.	India colourism / Dark is Beautiful.
Being different is bad.	Different is wonderful; everyone belongs.	Diversity / belonging.
Boys and girls can't be friends.	Anyone can be friends with anyone.	Friendship research.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy wonders aloud: "ooh... who can play with THIS?".
2. **Play.** One of seven mechanics, rotated, never the same twice in a row.
3. **Cheer.** A correct sort / built scene makes the canvas erupt and a doodle spring, the reward Vihaan stays for.
4. **UN → RE moment.** On a myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("pink is a girl colour" → "colours are for everyone").
5. **Apply.** Say it aloud, build the fair playground, or choose to include someone.
6. **Sticker.** The "anyone can" badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surfaces: the **drag-to-"anyone-can"** tray, the **dress-up / build** canvas, and **say-it-aloud** voice beats (audio-first for Kabir). Co-play prompts hand Megha and Sunita a real conversation.

Playful, never preachy.

- **Register.** Ages 3-6: warm, cheery, concrete; Lensy wonders, the child discovers; never a lecture.
- **Safe to be wrong.** No WRONG buzzer (Aria's fear); a misplaced sort gently re-asks; reflects have no wrong answer.
- **Don't preach.** Fairness framed as "everyone plays / everyone helps", so it lands across families (Sunita's "dadi nods along").
- **Both directions.** Frees girls toward bold/strong/lead AND boys toward gentle/care/cry; neither gender is the "problem".
- **Access.** Audio-first and voiced, offline, low-data, colour never the only signal; India names, foods, languages, skin tones; parent co-play.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. same-same-different** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** Each scenario carries type + typed payload (sort.items/bins/key, strike-rewrite.myth, role-play.yourLine, build.pieces, match.pairs, branch.options, reflect.options). Reuses the shared templates first built for g09.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, max 22%, 0% binary, 22 autonomy, 18 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Thread root.** Establishes the vocabulary the whole gender thread reuses (anyone-can, strong-and-gentle, equal-inside); keep terms stable.
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): no hard fail; both directions (open doors for girls and boys); never preachy; represent every kid & skin tone; counter colourism; made-for-India; co-play friendly.

Why this works.

- **The window is 3–6.** Children form gender stereotypes early in this band (Vihaan already sorts "girl colours"), and beliefs are still flexible, so well-timed counter-stereotype play is unusually effective here.
- **Play beats lecture.** Young children shift beliefs through counter-stereotype exposure plus explicit myth-naming, delivered as drag, build, voice and story, not "tap the right card", which they solve and abandon.
- **Co-play multiplies it.** Parent co-play turns the game into real conversation ("why is that a boys' toy?"), the persona-validated mechanism that makes the learning stick at home.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. Retrofit 1 of 9 (g01-08, g37) to the v2 standard; worst-offenders first. g04 was the most monotonous (72% single-mechanic) and is now scorecard-clean.